Pickaxe



Category: **Hand Tools - Striking & Digging** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 8 labs

Covers these lab items: Pick Axe; Pickaxe and spade; Pickaxe (Tikav) with wooden handle

What it is used for

Use a pickaxe to break compacted soil, loosen hard ground, or remove small rocks during approved digging tasks.

How to use

1. Inspect the head, eye, and handle for cracks, looseness, or damage.
2. Choose the pickaxe type suitable for the ground and task.
3. Check the work area for buried cables, pipes, and other hazards.
4. Stand with stable footing and keep people well clear of the swing area.
5. Grip the handle firmly and swing under control toward the target area.
6. Break material gradually and stop to remove loose pieces safely.
7. Clean the tool and inspect it after use.

⚠ Safety

- Wear safety glasses, gloves, and sturdy protective footwear.
- Never use a pickaxe with a loose head or damaged handle.
- Keep others outside the full swing and rebound zone.
- Do not strike near buried utilities until their location is confirmed.

Care & storage

- Remove soil and moisture from the head after use.
- Store the pickaxe securely with the head protected and handle supported.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.